Asia Summit dialogue process. India has taken due note of the increased attention given to the larger Indo-Pacific in the latest US National Security Strategy[30] and, of course, the decision to rename USPACOM to USINDOPACOM. It was widely noted in India that while renaming PACOM, US Secretary of Defence James Mattis quoted Admiral Harris's favourite description of the area of operations of the Command as covering the region "between Hollywood and Bollywood."[31] Further, the two countries' "strategic convergence in the Indo-Pacific" was reiterated in the joint statement issued during Trump's visit to India in February 2020. The joint statement referred to a close India–US partnership as "central to a free, open, inclusive, peaceful and prosperous Indo-Pacific region." It emphasised the commitment of the two countries to "sustainable, transparent, quality infrastructure development in the region." With the United States expressing appreciation for "India's role as a net provider of security, as well as developmental and humanitarian assistance in the Indian Ocean Region," the two countries spoke of fostering cooperation in third countries between India's Development Partnership Administration and the US Agency for International Aid.[32]

There is thus an essential similarity of approach between India and the United States in the Indo-Pacific region. They both would like Asian security to rest on the bedrock of a free, open, and inclusive architecture, based on international law. Nonetheless, even though India and the United States can indeed find common ground, they do not necessarily share the same vision for all of Asia. Looking eastward from India, there is greater congruence between the outlooks of India and the United States, but westward from India, there is a larger gap. The two countries do not take each other into confidence in the same way when they both look towards the region between Pakistan and the Persian Gulf and beyond. For one, they differ in their conceptualisation of the